

satisfyingly strong hold – it didn't fall off once during my daily backpack stow-and-go ritual.

Tablet mode genuinely works. That's not something I say lightly. Too many 2-in-1s treat tablet mode like an awkward second cousin – there, but not fully welcome. The OmniBook Flip makes it feel natural. I'd lean back, fold the screen around, and browse articles like I was reading a giant Kindle made of obsidian.

Performance: Enough muscle, zero fanfare

The Intel Core Ultra 7 258V (2.2GHz), paired with 32GB of RAM and a 1TB SSD, might sound like overkill for a laptop that won't see any AAA gaming. But that's exactly why it shines.

From video calls to layout work, web browsing to note-taking, everything happens without friction. Chrome didn't stutter once, even with 40 tabs open (yes, I checked). Google Docs sessions ran smoothly alongside Teams calls, YouTube videos, and the occasional Spotify stream – all without breaking a sweat.

I even ran local LLMs like GPT-OSS (20B), LLaMA 3.1 (8B), and DeepSeek (7B) via Ollama, just to see if the laptop could handle them. It did – admirably so – with a slight lag on text generation, as expected, but no crashes or tantrums.

One word of caution: this isn't a gaming machine. It doesn't try to be. The integrated Intel Arc GPU is fine for creative workloads and light visuals, but if you're planning to frag enemies in 4K or render Blender projects on the go, you're in the wrong aisle.

Battery that lasts (and lasts)

With brightness set to 40% and Wi-Fi constantly humming, I routinely got more than a full day of use. That's a decent 9 to 12 hours without any range anxiety, depending on what I was doing. From morning edits to post-dinner streaming, I rarely reached for the charger before bedtime.

And when I did, the 67W Type-C fast charger (borrowed from my Xiaomi



smartphone, no less) topped up the battery from near zero to 100% in just under two hours. That's super speedy, if you ask me.

A webcam that finally gets the memo

I didn't expect much from the 5MP webcam – laptop webcams are usually the weakest link – but this one genuinely surprised me. On Teams, Zoom, and the occasional WhatsApp video call, my image looked sharper and more colour-accurate than expected, even in mixed lighting.

More importantly, the hardware privacy shutter and mic mute button are right there, easy to access, and weirdly satisfying to flick. When you've spent three hours on back-to-back work calls in noisy cafes or coworking spaces, those tiny design choices start to feel like life savers.

Some trade-off to note

Let's get the nitpicks out of the way. The onboard speakers are just okay. Not bad, not tinny – just okay. Good enough for watching videos solo, not loud enough for a crowded room or impromptu jam session.

Also, while I appreciate the generous I/O options – two USB-A ports, two USB-C ports, HDMI 2.1, DisplayPort 1.4a, and a 3.5mm audio jack – there's no SD card reader. For creators who still swear by their DSLR workflows, that might be a miss.

The laptop's aesthetics lean professional and premium, it's not the most distinctive design. It won't turn heads like a Spectre or a Surface – but maybe that's the point. It's a workhorse dressed in executive grey, not a peacock.

A hybrid worth aspiring to

The HP OmniBook X Flip 14 isn't cheap. It floats well north of ₹1,30,000, firmly in premium laptop territory. But for that price, you're getting a machine that walks the hybrid talk – not just in form, but in function. It's sturdy, thoughtfully built, dependable under pressure, and flexible enough to adapt to how (and where) you work.

For creators who sketch as much as they write, for business professionals tired of flimsy 2-in-1s, or even for students in grad school wanting one machine that does it all, this is a hybrid laptop that earns its flip.

In a world increasingly full of compromises – where laptops are getting thinner, weaker, more disposable – the OmniBook X Flip 14 feels like a machine built to last. And in 2025, that's saying something. **d**

SPECIFICATIONS:

Display: 14-inch OLED display (2880x1800 resolution, 16:10 aspect ratio) | **CPU:** Intel Core Ultra 7 258V (2.20 GHz) | **GPU:** Intel Arc 140V (16GB) | **RAM:** 32GB | **SSD:** 1TB | **Connectivity:** 2 x USB-A ports, 2 x USB-C ports, 1 x HDMI 2.1 port, 1 x DisplayPort 1.4a combo port, 1 x 3.5mm audio jack | **Wireless:** Wi-Fi 7, Bluetooth 5.4 | **Battery:** 3-cell, 59 WhLi-ion polymer

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